Attendance & Workforce Management System

Setup & Operating Guide — install from scratch, run every day, and fix common issues

On-premises install for a Windows office PC · Your data never leaves this computer

What you need

• A **Windows 10 or 11** PC (64-bit), at least **8 GB RAM** and **~20 GB** free disk. This PC stays on during office hours and acts as the server.

• The **delivery folder** you were given (it contains this guide, the app images, and the `start-attendance.bat` launcher).

• Your **admin sign-in** and **license key** (sent to you separately by your provider).

You do NOT install Python, databases, or anything else. Everything runs inside Docker. The only program you install is Docker Desktop (Step 1).

Step 1 — Install Docker Desktop (one time, ~15 min)

1. Open **https://www.docker.com/products/docker-desktop** and download **Docker Desktop for Windows**.

2. Run the installer. Keep **"Use WSL 2"** ticked. Finish, then **restart the PC**.

3. If Docker warns that virtualization is off: restart, enter the PC's BIOS/UEFI, turn on **Virtualization** (also called *SVM* or *Intel VT-x*), save, and reboot. This is a one-time step.

4. Start **Docker Desktop** from the Start menu and wait until the whale icon in the taskbar says **"Docker Desktop is running."**

Important — make it start by itself after every reboot:

5. In Docker Desktop click the **gear (Settings)** → **General**, tick **"Start Docker Desktop when you sign in to your computer,"** then **Apply & Restart**.

This one setting is what makes the whole system come back on its own after a power cut or reboot — you will not have to start anything manually (see "Every reboot" below).

Step 2 — Start the Attendance System (first run)

1. Copy the delivery folder to a permanent place, for example `C:\AttendanceSystem`. Don't run it from a USB stick or Downloads.

2. Double-click **start-attendance.bat**. The first run loads the app (a few minutes) and creates its configuration automatically. Leave the window until it says **Done**.

3. On this PC, open a browser and go to **http://localhost**.

4. Sign in as **admin** with the credentials your provider gave you. In **Admin** → **Settings**, paste your **license key** if it isn't already active.

From now on every part of the system is set to restart automatically, so after Step 1's auto-start setting you normally never touch these files again.

Step 3 — Let staff use it from their phones / other PCs

Everyone on the same office Wi-Fi opens the system in their browser using this PC's address.

1. Find this PC's address: double-click **update-ip.bat** — it prints the address to use (for example `http://192.168.1.50` or your `.duckdns.org` web address if one was set up for you).

2. Share that address with staff. They open it on the office Wi-Fi and sign in.

Phone camera (selfie check-in) needs HTTPS. Phone browsers only open the camera on a secure (https) address. To enable it, right-click **setup-https.ps1** → **Run with PowerShell** once, then have each phone trust the certificate the first time (the guide it prints explains how). After that, staff use the `https://` address.

Every reboot / turning the PC on

If you ticked the auto-start setting in Step 1, there is **nothing to do**:

• Turn the PC on → Docker Desktop starts by itself → the attendance system starts by itself.

• Give it 1–2 minutes after login, then open **http://localhost** to confirm it's up.

If the page does not load after a couple of minutes:

1. Check the taskbar for the Docker **whale icon**. If it isn't there, open **Docker Desktop** from the Start menu and wait for “running.”

2. Still not loading? Double-click **start-attendance.bat** once — it will start anything that didn't come up.

To stop the system on purpose (e.g. before shutting the PC for a long holiday), double-click **stop-attendance.bat**. To start it again, use **start-attendance.bat**.

Backups (do this — it protects your data)

• A backup is taken **automatically at the end of every month** into the `backups` folder next to these files.

• For an instant backup any time, use **Admin** → **Settings** → **Data** → **Download Backup Now** (saves a `.dump` file), or double-click **backup.bat**.

• **Copy the backups off this PC regularly** — onto a USB drive or another computer. A backup on the same PC won't help if the PC itself fails.

• To restore: **Admin** → **Settings** → **Data** → **Restore** and upload a `.dump` file (this replaces current data).

Optional: double-click **setup-backup-task.bat** once to add a Windows scheduled task that backs up on a regular schedule automatically.

Enrolling faces & daily use

• **Add staff:** Admin or HR → **Employees** → **Add Employee**.

• **Enrol a face:** on the Employees list, click the **camera icon** on a person's row and upload 1–3 clear, front-facing photos. Only a numeric face fingerprint is stored; the photos are discarded.

• **Three ways to mark attendance:** office camera (Admin → Camera), each employee's phone **selfie check-in**, or a connected **ZKTeco** fingerprint device.

• **Passwords:** staff who forget a password ask Admin/HR, who set a new one from **Employees** → **edit the person** → **Reset Password**.

• **Notifications:** in-app alerts always work with no setup. To also send **WhatsApp** and/or **email** alerts, turn them on in **Admin** → **Settings** → **Notifications** (WhatsApp needs a free Meta WhatsApp Cloud API key; email needs an SMTP account).

The separate **USER-GUIDE** in this folder covers leave, reimbursements, approvals and reports for everyday users.

Troubleshooting — common problems & fixes

Symptom	Fix

Staff / phones suddenly can't open the address (the PC's IP changed)	The PC's IP changed after a Wi-Fi or router change. Double-click update-ip.bat — it re-poin
The site doesn't load at all (even http://localhost)	Docker isn't running yet. Open Docker Desktop, wait for the whale to say 'running' (1-2 min
start-attendance.bat says 'Docker is not running'	Start Docker Desktop first and wait for 'running', then run start-attendance.bat again.
Phone won't open the camera for selfie check-in	The camera needs HTTPS. Run setup-https.ps1 (right-click - Run with PowerShell) and tru
Someone forgot their password	Admin/HR opens Employees - edit that person - Reset Password, and shares the new pass
Data looks empty / you moved to a new PC	Install Docker + start-attendance.bat on the new PC, then restore your latest .dump from A
'Port 80 is already in use' on first start	Another app (e.g. IIS or an old web server) is using port 80. Stop it, or ask your provider to
A setting changed in Admin isn't taking effect	Give it a moment and refresh the browser. If it still lags, restart via stop-attendance.bat ther

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Your data (staff, attendance, enrolled faces) stays on this PC inside Docker and is never sent to the internet. Keep Docker Desktop set to start on login, and keep copies of the backups folder off-machine. For anything not covered here, contact your provider.